

The Fretful Dragon

Those who think that Sino-Indian friendship is a reality are either day-dreamers or being simply foolish ("Beijing Games", June 23). China is more dangerous than our arch enemy Pakistan. Let us not forget 1962 when it fooled Nehru and attacked an ill-prepared India. Ignoring such intrusions on our soil is suicidal. **A.K. SHARMA, Chandigarh**

China has never been too happy about India's progress. It is unable to digest our good relations with prominent nation-states like the USA and Russia, and has always striven to keep us under some pressure. We will have to learn to live with this hostility as one can choose his friends, not neighbours. **VIRENDRA KUMAR TANGRI, Dehradun**

By hosting the Olympic Games, China may well want to show the world that it is interested only in tracks and fields, but in the background, it will always play games of trick and greed. **RAJNEESH BATRA, Delhi**

It must be a sore disappointment for all the right thinking people that despite India's good trade relations with China and all diplomatic efforts to diffuse the tension on the border, the dragon has been consistently letting loose terror. **K.R. SRINIVASAN, Chennai**

Charge of the Red Brigade

For the new rulers of Nepal, it would really be a tough task to be able to hold several political

parties together to usher in a democratic era in the troubled Himalayan nation ("Birth Pangs", June 23). **K.S. THAMPI, Chennai**

India should be on its guard as far as the Maoists are concerned due to their affinity with China and a long history of violence. We should be watchful about their activities on the border and make sure that Indian Maoists do not get any assistance from Nepal. **MAYA AGARWAL, on e-mail**

It seems that Nepal would follow India's example in terms of its unstable governments with too many parties forming unrealistic and opportunist alliances. **SUBHASH CHANDRA AGRAWAL, Delhi**

There are reasons to believe that Nepal and China would unite against India due to the former's ideological connect and the latter's expansionist strategy. **J. N. BHARTIYA, Lucknow**



The thoroughly-researched cover story on IPL deserves accolades ("20:20 Vision", June 16). The packaging of the tournament by BCCI was superb and the extraordinary hype created by innovative ideas persuaded everyone to take sides. The presence of stars, however, could not divert the attention from cricket and from the fact that sincere hard work and team spirit can do wonders. Rajasthan Royals' triumph justified that.

RAJESH KHOTH, Sirsa

The popularity of IPL proves that as in cricket, where young players have delivered the goods, the nation needs fresh blood in politics too. They should take cue from older players like Javagal Srinath who retired from the game gracefully when they could not handle the pressure of the game. And just as things improved drastically in cricket when we were able to become world champions, the presence of young crop of leaders too would make the country a global power.

RATAN SHARGA, on e-mail

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Years Ago in India Today

JULY 16-31, 1978



Kissa Kursi Ka

Is this the beginning of the end? At the close of 16 months of rule, the most fervent of Janata Party apologists have run out of explanations. The most seasoned of political quacks have exhausted their cures; it is time for soothsayers and sycophants to seek their customers anew. Not all the king's horsemen can put together the pieces again. And like the original egghead's fate in the nursery rhyme, there is something fatalistic about the Janata's fall.



Those who **Morarji Desai** have viewed the scenario unfold in the monsoon-soaked capital over the last two weeks are justified perhaps in comparing it to a second-rate potboiler. And the *dramatis personae*, diverse though it may be, is made of characters whose overriding quest for power leaps out of the pages of cheap dramatic fiction. There is certainly something fictional about the presence of Janata Party today.

—Sunil Sethi

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